



Windows Phone

Although it currently has a negligible market share, with the launch of 7 many factions, including developers are considering taking it seriously

Make an app now

Go to the link below for a video on how to create a simple data app in Visual Studio <http://bit.ly/cvICtG>

Careers in Mobile App Development

With the Apps and Smartphone industry growing in leaps and bounds it's the perfect time to think about a career in this field



Siddharth Parwatay
siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

Who could've imagined in the time of an innocuous little app called Snake, that the Mobile App Development Industry would be where it is today. A recent ABI Research report found that consumers downloaded 2.4 billion applications last year, and the downloads are on an explosive rise to the tune of 7 billion by 2013. Others estimate the industry is size to grow to about \$17.2 billion by 2013.

Back in the day carriers had a walled garden approach, strictly controlling the app content worldwide and in countries like India the developer revenue share was as low as 30%. Apple came in with the AppStore and in one fell swoop changed the game for everyone, developers et al. This was followed by the Android Market and Ovi Store from Nokia. Today we have

various platforms present in the market that run on mobile phones, tablets and even netbooks; viz Adobe AIR, Java ME, Meego, Symbian, Android, iOS (Apple), Samsung bada, RIM (Blackberry), Windows Mobile, Brew and many more.

"The app industry is one of the most rapidly evolving technology fronts right now. Devices like Mobile Phones, Tablets and very soon home appliances are going to run apps. Apps that can be downloaded, Apps that can connect to the internet and Apps that can define lifestyles," said Noaman Kazi, Business lead at Hungama Digital Media Entertainment Limited. "We are currently leveraging the Android SDK to build

solutions for customised Tablet devices" said Siddharth Sharma from RapidSoft Technologies, an Indian app development company which caters to telecom clients such as AT&T, Telefonica and Verizon.

Development landscape demystified

The entire developer ecosystem can broadly be categorised the demand side and the supply side. On the demand side you have gaming, publishing, and content companies trying to develop something on their own in the mobile space. This kind of content could even be in the cloud since you have a web interface on mobiles as well. The second category are people who are developing their own applications and porting those application on to the different marketplaces. The third category are OPDs or Offshore Product Development companies that exploit the arbitrage opportunity that is created in this space. On the supply side there are again three profiles for mobile developers - MIS developers who form a part of a large enterprise organisation whose concerns are compatibility, scalability, security etc. The second are the game developers who work across the platforms. The third category is web developers working in the mobile space who develop mobile web pages or Rich Internet Applications.

Education, Certification and Employment

The people most suited for this field are those coming from a technical background. They could be BE or BTech, BCA, MCA or Computer Science graduates. Such courses impart a certain amount of base knowledge in terms of coding such as C++ or C# or technologies such as J2EE. But these curriculum driven skill-sets do not necessarily prepare students for employability. Perhaps this is why you have India-based training institutes such as www.FresherLab.com and www.edumobile.org cropping up. "In



"We are now working through our academic initiatives, to reach out to the entire academic community in India to build capabilities both on the mobile and cloud fronts"

Moorthy Uppaluri, General Manager, Developer Partner Evangelism, Microsoft India